

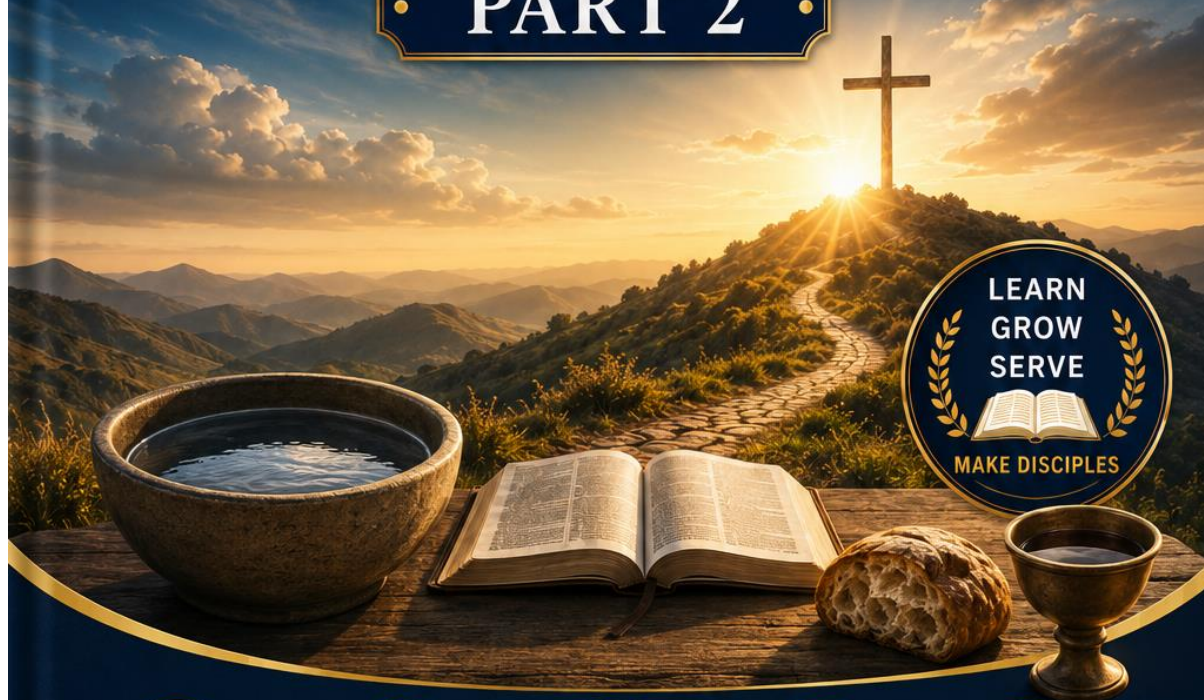


A BIBLICAL GUIDE TO GROWTH,
MATURITY, AND MAKING DISCIPLES

DISCIPLESHIP

Following Jesus and Becoming Like Him

• PART 2 •



BAPTISM &
THE LORD'S SUPPER



PRAYER



FELLOWSHIP



BIBLE STUDY



WORSHIP &
SERVICE



GRACEPATH
NETWORK

GROWING IN CHRIST. WALKING IN GRACE. IMPACTING LIVES.

DISCIPLESHIP – PART 2

Introduction

Part One of this discipleship journey focused on the foundations of the Christian faith. We learned what it means to be a disciple, considered the cost of following Jesus, and discovered the assurance that comes through salvation in Christ. These truths provide the essential groundwork for a growing relationship with God.

Part Two moves beyond the foundation and introduces believers to the spiritual practices and relationships that nurture a healthy and fruitful Christian life. A disciple is not only someone who believes in Jesus but also someone who continually grows in intimacy with Him, obeys His commands, and lives in fellowship with other believers.

In these lessons, we will study important subjects such as **Baptism and the Lord's Supper, Prayer, Fellowship, Bible Study, Worship, Stewardship, and Christian Service**. These spiritual disciplines help believers remain connected to Christ, strengthen their faith, and equip them to serve effectively in God's Kingdom.

Spiritual growth does not happen automatically. Just as a healthy plant requires water, sunlight, and nourishment, believers need regular communion with God, faithful participation in the life of the Church, and consistent obedience to God's Word. Through these practices, the Holy Spirit shapes our character, deepens our understanding of Scripture, and enables us to bear lasting fruit.

God desires His children to become mature disciples who reflect the love, holiness, and compassion of Jesus Christ. As we devote ourselves to prayer, worship, fellowship, and service, we become channels through which God blesses others and advances His Kingdom.

May Part Two encourage you to develop habits that strengthen your walk with God, deepen your love for His people, and inspire you to serve Him with joy and faithfulness.

Theme Scripture

Acts 2:42 (NKJV)

"And they continued steadfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and in prayers."

Opening Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for saving me and bringing me into Your family. Teach me to grow deeper in my relationship with You through prayer, worship, fellowship, and obedience. Help me to develop spiritual disciplines that honour You and strengthen my faith. May my life reflect the character of Jesus Christ and become a blessing to others.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

CHAPTER 1

Baptism and the Lord's Supper

Theme Scripture

Matthew 28:19–20 (NKJV)

"Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all things that I have commanded you..."

Key Verse

Acts 2:41 (NKJV)

"Then those who gladly received his word were baptized; and that day about three thousand souls were added to them."

Introduction

After receiving salvation through faith in Jesus Christ, believers are called to publicly identify with Him and participate in practices He established for His Church. Two important ordinances given by Jesus are **Baptism** and **The Lord's Supper**.

These ordinances do not save anyone, but they are acts of obedience that strengthen faith, proclaim the Gospel, and remind believers of Christ's work on their behalf.

Baptism is a testimony that a person has become a follower of Jesus Christ. The Lord's Supper is a continual remembrance of Christ's sacrifice until He returns.

Understanding these ordinances helps disciples appreciate the grace of God and walk faithfully in obedience.

1. What Is Baptism?

Baptism is an outward expression of an inward transformation.

It is a public declaration that a person has trusted Jesus Christ as Lord and Saviour.

Baptism symbolizes:

- Identification with Christ
- Death to the old life
- Burial of the sinful nature
- Resurrection to a new life in Christ

Romans 6:4 (NKJV)

"Therefore we were buried with Him through baptism into death, that just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life."

2. Who Should Be Baptized?

Baptism is intended for those who have personally believed in Jesus Christ.

Examples in Scripture show people believing first and then being baptized.

Acts 8:36–38 (NKJV)

The Ethiopian official believed the message concerning Jesus and was baptized immediately.

Biblical Pattern

Hear the Gospel

Believe in Christ

Repent

Be baptized

Grow in discipleship

3. Why Should Believers Be Baptized?

Jesus Commanded It

Matthew 28:19

Jesus instructed His followers to baptize new believers.

Jesus Was Baptized

Matthew 3:13–17

Jesus Himself was baptized, setting an example for His followers.

Baptism Demonstrates Obedience

A disciple desires to obey Christ in every area of life.

Baptism Strengthens Testimony

Publicly declaring faith encourages other believers and serves as a witness to unbelievers.

4. Misunderstandings About Baptism

Baptism does not remove sin.

Baptism does not guarantee salvation.

Baptism is not a substitute for repentance.

Salvation comes through faith in Jesus Christ alone.

Ephesians 2:8–9 (NKJV)

"For by grace you have been saved through faith... not of works."

5. What Is the Lord's Supper?

The Lord's Supper was instituted by Jesus on the night before His crucifixion.

It is also called:

- Communion
- Breaking of Bread
- The Table of the Lord

1 Corinthians 11:23–24 (NKJV)

"The Lord Jesus on the same night in which He was betrayed took bread..."

6. The Meaning of the Bread

The bread represents the body of Christ.

Jesus willingly offered Himself for humanity.

Luke 22:19 (NKJV)

"This is My body which is given for you; do this in remembrance of Me."

The bread reminds believers of:

Christ's suffering

His sacrifice

His love

His victory over sin

7. The Meaning of the Cup

The cup represents the blood of Jesus Christ.

His blood established a new covenant between God and humanity.

Matthew 26:28 (NKJV)

"For this is My blood of the new covenant, which is shed for many for the remission of sins."

The cup reminds believers that forgiveness was purchased at a great cost.

8. How Should Believers Participate?

Communion should be observed reverently.

Believers are encouraged to examine their hearts before participating.

1 Corinthians 11:28 (NKJV)

"But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of the bread and drink of the cup."

Questions for self-examination:

Am I living in obedience to God?

Do I need to confess sin?

Have I forgiven others?

Am I walking in love toward fellow believers?

9. Looking Forward to Christ's Return

Communion points believers toward the future.

Jesus promised that one day He would share fellowship with His people in His Kingdom.

1 Corinthians 11:26 (NKJV)

"For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord's death till He comes."

Every observance of the Lord's Supper is a reminder that Jesus is coming again.

Illustration

A wedding ring does not create a marriage, but it symbolizes a covenant relationship.

In the same way, baptism does not save a person, but it symbolizes a transformed life in Christ.

Communion does not earn forgiveness, but it reminds believers of the sacrifice that secured their redemption.

Reflection Questions

1. Why is baptism important for believers?
2. What does baptism symbolize?
3. What do the bread and cup represent?
4. Why should believers examine themselves before taking Communion?
5. How does the Lord's Supper strengthen your faith?

Memory Verse

Romans 6:4 (NKJV)

"Therefore we were buried with Him through baptism into death... even so we also should walk in newness of life."

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for the gift of salvation through Jesus Christ. Help me to obey Your commands joyfully and faithfully. May baptism remind me of my new life in Christ, and may the Lord's Supper continually renew my gratitude for Your sacrifice. Teach me to walk in holiness and expectation as I await the return of Jesus.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

Points to Remember

- Baptism is an act of obedience and a public testimony of faith.
- Salvation comes through faith in Christ, not through baptism.
- The Lord's Supper commemorates Christ's death and resurrection.
- Communion calls believers to self-examination and thanksgiving.
- Both ordinances point believers toward the hope of Christ's return.

CHAPTER 2

Prayer: Developing Intimacy with God

Theme Scripture

Jeremiah 33:3 (NKJV)

“Call to Me, and I will answer you, and show you great and mighty things, which you do not know.”

Key Verse

1 Thessalonians 5:17 (NKJV)

“Pray without ceasing.”

Introduction

Prayer is one of the greatest privileges given to believers. Through prayer, we communicate with our Heavenly Father, express our love for Him, seek His guidance, and receive strength for daily living.

Prayer is not merely a religious duty or a ritual to be performed. It is a relationship. Just as healthy relationships require communication, our relationship with God grows stronger as we spend time talking with Him and listening to His voice.

Jesus Himself demonstrated the importance of prayer. Although He was the Son of God, He regularly withdrew from crowds to spend time alone with His Father. If Jesus considered prayer essential, how much more should His followers value it?

A disciple who neglects prayer will struggle spiritually, but a disciple who develops a consistent prayer life will experience growth, peace, wisdom, and power.

1. What Is Prayer?

Prayer is communicating with God.

It involves:

- Speaking to God
- Listening to God
- Worshiping God
- Thanking God
- Confessing sins
- Presenting requests
- Interceding for others

Prayer is not limited to certain places or times. Believers can pray anywhere and at any moment.

Philippians 4:6 (NKJV)

“Be anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer and supplication, with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God.”

2. Why Should We Pray?

Prayer is important because it strengthens our relationship with God.

We Pray Because God Commands It

Luke 18:1 (NKJV)

“Men always ought to pray and not lose heart.”

We Pray Because We Depend on God

Human wisdom and strength are limited.

Prayer reminds us that our help comes from the Lord.

Psalms 121:1–2 (NKJV)

“My help comes from the LORD, who made heaven and earth.”

We Pray Because Prayer Changes Things

God responds to the prayers of His people.

James 5:16 (NKJV)

“The effective, fervent prayer of a righteous man avails much.”

Prayer may not always change circumstances immediately, but it often changes the person who is praying.

3. Jesus' Example of Prayer

Jesus frequently prayed.

Before Beginning His Ministry

Luke 3:21–22

Jesus prayed at His baptism.

Before Choosing the Twelve Disciples

Luke 6:12

Jesus spent the night in prayer.

Before His Crucifixion

Matthew 26:39

Jesus prayed in the Garden of Gethsemane.

On the Cross

Luke 23:34

Jesus prayed for those who crucified Him.

Prayer was central to the life and ministry of Jesus.

4. The Model Prayer

Jesus taught His disciples how to pray.

Matthew 6:9–13 (NKJV)

Our Father in heaven

Recognize God as your loving Father.

Hallowed be Your name

Worship and honour Him.

Your kingdom come

Desire God's will above personal desires.

Give us this day our daily bread

Present your needs to God.

Forgive us our debts

Confess sins and seek forgiveness.

Lead us not into temptation

Ask for protection and guidance.

5. Types of Prayer

Prayer of Worship

Praising God for who He is.

Prayer of Thanksgiving

Expressing gratitude for His blessings.

Prayer of Confession

Acknowledging sins before God.

Prayer of Petition

Presenting personal needs.

Prayer of Intercession

Praying for other people.

6. Hindrances to Prayer

Several things can weaken our prayer life.

Unconfessed Sin

Psalms 66:18 (NKJV)

“If I regard iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear.”

Unforgiveness

Bitterness affects fellowship with God.

Doubt

James 1:6 (NKJV)

“But let him ask in faith, with no doubting.”

Neglect

Busyness and distractions often crowd out prayer.

7. Developing a Consistent Prayer Life

Choose a regular time for prayer.

Find a quiet place.

Keep a prayer journal.

Pray through Scripture.

Pray with other believers.

Remain persistent.

Luke 11:9 (NKJV)

“Ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and it will be opened to you.”

Illustration

A branch disconnected from a tree eventually dries up because it no longer receives nourishment.

Likewise, believers who neglect prayer become spiritually weak because they are not drawing strength from their relationship with God.

Prayer keeps us connected to the source of life.

Reflection Questions

1. How would you describe your current prayer life?

2. What challenges hinder you from praying consistently?
 3. Which type of prayer do you practice most often?
 4. How can you improve your communication with God?
 5. What answers to prayer have strengthened your faith?
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Memory Verse

Jeremiah 33:3 (NKJV)

“Call to Me, and I will answer you, and show you great and mighty things, which you do not know.”

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for inviting me into fellowship with You through prayer. Teach me to seek You daily, trust You completely, and depend upon Your strength. Help me develop a consistent prayer life that honours You and transforms my heart. May my prayers align with Your will and bring glory to Your name.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

Points to Remember

- Prayer is communication with God.
 - Jesus demonstrated the importance of prayer.
 - Prayer strengthens our relationship with God.
 - God invites believers to pray persistently and with faith.
 - A healthy prayer life is essential for spiritual growth.
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CHAPTER 3

FELLOWSHIP

Theme Scripture

Hebrews 10:25

"Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as is the manner of some, but exhorting one another, and so much the more as you see the Day approaching." (NKJV)

Introduction

Christianity was never meant to be lived in isolation. When God saves us, He places us into a spiritual family called the Church. Every believer needs other believers for encouragement, support, correction, and growth.

Many people today desire a personal relationship with Jesus but neglect fellowship with other Christians. While personal devotion is important, spiritual maturity develops best when believers worship, pray, learn, and serve together.

The early church understood this truth. They met regularly, shared meals, prayed together, and cared for one another. Their fellowship strengthened their faith and enabled them to withstand persecution and hardship.

God designed believers to grow together.

What is Fellowship?

Biblical fellowship means much more than attending church services. It is sharing life together in Christ.

Fellowship includes:

- Worshiping together

- Studying God's Word together
- Praying for one another
- Serving together
- Encouraging one another
- Sharing joys and burdens
- Building meaningful Christian friendships

Fellowship creates an environment where believers can mature spiritually and experience God's love through His people.

Why Fellowship is Important

1. Fellowship Provides Encouragement

Life can be difficult. Christians face temptations, disappointments, trials, and spiritual battles.

Encouragement from fellow believers helps us remain strong.

Romans 1:12

"That I may be encouraged together with you by the mutual faith both of you and me."

A simple prayer, visit, message, or conversation can renew someone's faith.

2. Fellowship Provides Accountability

Believers help one another stay faithful to God.

Sometimes we do not recognize our own weaknesses. Trusted Christian friends can lovingly correct us and guide us back to the right path.

Proverbs 27:17

"As iron sharpens iron, so a man sharpens the countenance of his friend."

Accountability protects believers from drifting away from God.

3. Fellowship Builds Friendships

God created human beings for relationships.

Christian friendships are different because they are centered on Christ.

These friendships:

- Offer support during difficult times
- Celebrate victories together
- Provide wise counsel
- Strengthen faith

Jesus Himself enjoyed fellowship with His disciples.

John 15:15

"I have called you friends."

4. Fellowship Promotes Spiritual Growth

Believers learn from one another.

Older Christians can mentor younger believers.

Experienced believers can teach, encourage, and demonstrate how to live a godly life.

Ephesians 4:15–16

"But, speaking the truth in love, may grow up in all things into Him who is the head—Christ."

Growth happens when believers are connected and functioning together.

The Example of the Early Church

The first Christians devoted themselves to fellowship.

Acts 2:42

"And they continued steadfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and in prayers."

The early church practiced fellowship through:

Learning Together

They listened to the teaching of God's Word.

Eating Together

Sharing meals strengthened their relationships.

Praying Together

They united in prayer for one another.

Helping One Another

Believers shared resources and cared for those in need.

Because of their unity, many people were drawn to Christ.

Fellowship with God and Others

Christian fellowship begins with fellowship with God.

1 John 1:3

"Truly our fellowship is with the Father and with His Son Jesus Christ."

As we draw closer to God, we also grow closer to His people.

Hindrances to Fellowship

Some believers avoid fellowship because of:

Busyness

Work and personal commitments may consume our time.

Past Hurts

Negative experiences in churches can discourage people.

Fear

Some people feel shy or believe they will not be accepted.

Pride

Pride can prevent believers from opening their lives to others.

Overcoming These Hindrances

We can overcome barriers to fellowship by:

- Making fellowship a priority
 - Forgiving those who hurt us
 - Joining a Bible study or small group
 - Participating in church activities
 - Serving alongside other believers
 - Being willing to build new friendships
-

Practical Ways to Fellowship

You can strengthen fellowship by:

- Attending church faithfully
- Participating in prayer meetings
- Visiting other believers
- Calling or messaging someone who needs encouragement
- Sharing meals together
- Joining ministry teams
- Studying the Bible with friends

- Supporting members during times of sickness or loss

Small acts of kindness can greatly strengthen the body of Christ.

Reflection Questions

1. Why do believers need fellowship?
 2. What benefits have you experienced through Christian friendships?
 3. What obstacles keep people from participating in fellowship?
 4. How can you become a better encourager to others?
 5. What practical step can you take this week to strengthen fellowship?
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Memory Verse

Hebrews 10:25

"Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as is the manner of some, but exhorting one another, and so much the more as you see the Day approaching." (NKJV)

Points to Remember

- ✓ God designed believers to grow together.
- ✓ Fellowship provides encouragement.
- ✓ Fellowship promotes accountability.
- ✓ Christian friendships strengthen faith.
- ✓ Spiritual growth flourishes in community.
- ✓ Every believer should actively participate in the life of the Church.

Prayer

Heavenly Father, thank You for placing me in Your family. Help me to value fellowship with other believers. Teach me to encourage others, build meaningful relationships, and grow together with Your people. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Conclusion – Discipleship Part 2

As we conclude **Part Two** of this discipleship journey, we are reminded that spiritual growth requires intentional commitment and daily dependence upon God. The Christian life is not sustained by a one-time decision but by a continuing relationship with Jesus Christ that grows stronger through obedience, worship, prayer, and fellowship.

In these lessons, we have explored important practices that help believers mature in their faith. We learned that **baptism and the Lord's Supper** are meaningful ordinances established by Christ to strengthen our testimony and remind us of His sacrifice. We discovered that **prayer** is a privilege through which we communicate with our Heavenly Father, seek His guidance, and receive strength for everyday living. We also saw that **fellowship** is essential because God designed believers to encourage, support, and grow together as members of one spiritual family.

Spiritual maturity does not happen overnight. It develops as believers faithfully practice these disciplines, remain connected to the body of Christ, and allow the Holy Spirit to transform their hearts. Healthy disciples do not merely receive

blessings from God; they become instruments through whom God blesses others.

As you move forward, make a commitment to cultivate a consistent prayer life, participate actively in Christian fellowship, faithfully observe the ordinances of the Church, and seek opportunities to serve and encourage others. Through these practices, your faith will deepen, your character will be strengthened, and your influence for Christ will increase.

May the Lord continue to guide you, empower you, and help you grow into a mature disciple who reflects the love, grace, and truth of Jesus Christ.

Closing Scripture

Colossians 2:6–7 (NKJV)

"As you therefore have received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk in Him, rooted and built up in Him and established in the faith, as you have been taught, abounding in it with thanksgiving."

Closing Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for teaching me through these lessons and helping me grow in my walk with You.

Strengthen my faith, deepen my prayer life, and help me value fellowship with other believers. Teach me to obey Your Word, serve faithfully, and become a disciple who brings glory to Your name. Continue Your work in my life until I become more like Jesus Christ.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

DISCIPLESHIP – PART 2

Final Examination

SECTION A: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

Choose the correct answer. (2 Marks each)

1. Baptism is primarily:

- A. A means of salvation
- B. An act of obedience
- C. A church tradition
- D. A requirement for membership

2. Baptism symbolizes:

- A. Joining a denomination
- B. Death, burial, and resurrection with Christ
- C. Receiving spiritual gifts

- D. Becoming perfect
3. The Lord's Supper was instituted by Jesus:
- A. At His baptism
 - B. During His temptation
 - C. Before His crucifixion
 - D. After His resurrection
4. The bread in Communion represents:
- A. The Church
 - B. The Body of Christ
 - C. The Holy Spirit
 - D. Eternal life
5. Prayer is best described as:
- A. A religious ceremony
 - B. Communicating with God
 - C. Reading Scripture
 - D. Singing hymns
6. Jesus taught His disciples to pray in:
- A. Matthew 6
 - B. Matthew 10
 - C. Mark 5
 - D. John 17
7. According to Hebrews 10:25 believers should:
- A. Worship alone
 - B. Avoid gatherings
 - C. Meet together regularly
 - D. Pray only at home
8. Fellowship provides:

- A. Isolation
- B. Discouragement
- C. Accountability
- D. Competition

9. The early believers devoted themselves to:

- A. Entertainment
- B. Fellowship and prayer
- C. Politics
- D. Business

10. Prayer changes:

- A. Nothing
- B. Only circumstances
- C. Both people and circumstances
- D. God's character

SECTION B: TRUE OR FALSE

Write TRUE or FALSE. (2 Marks each)

- 11. Baptism removes sin. _____
- 12. Salvation comes through faith in Christ alone. _____
- 13. Communion reminds believers of Christ's sacrifice. _____
- 14. Jesus rarely prayed. _____

15. Prayer strengthens our relationship with God. _____
16. Fellowship was important in the early Church. _____
17. Christians can grow spiritually in complete isolation. _____
18. Unforgiveness can hinder prayer.

19. Accountability helps believers remain faithful. _____
20. God desires believers to grow together.

A BIBLICAL GUIDE TO GROWTH,
MATURITY, AND MAKING DISCIPLES

DISCIPLESHIP

• PART 2 •

Following Jesus and Becoming Like Him

Part Two explores essential spiritual practices every disciple needs to grow deeper in Christ and walk faithfully in His ways.

Learn the meaning and importance of Baptism and the Lord's Supper, the power of prayer, the value of fellowship, and how these disciplines build a strong and vibrant Christian life.

Grow in grace. Walk in obedience.
Impact lives for God's Kingdom.



BAPTISM & THE LORD'S SUPPER

Understand the meaning and purpose of these ordinances and their impact on your faith.



PRAYER

Discover the power of prayer and how to develop a deeper prayer life.



FELLOWSHIP

Build meaningful relationships and grow together in the body of Christ.



BIBLE STUDY & WORSHIP

Learn to love God's Word and worship Him in spirit and in truth.



SERVICE & MATURITY

Serve others with Christ-like love and become a mature, fruitful disciple.



"Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all things that I have commanded you..."

MATTHEW 28:19-20 (NKJV)

“

And they continued steadfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and in prayers.”

– Acts 2:42 (NKJV)



GROWING IN CHRIST. WALKING IN GRACE. IMPACTING LIVES.

Whether you are new in your faith or growing in maturity, this guide will equip you to follow Jesus, live obediently, and make a lasting difference in the lives of others.

SCAN TO DISCOVER MORE

Free resources, discipleship tools, and encouragement for your journey.



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